Shah Jahan & the Evolution of the Mughal Ruling Class

Continuous at-a-glance rail: power, composition, mansab-jagir adjustment and the 1657-58 transfer crisis

1

1. Frame

Visible apex + managed strain; strict topic boundaries.

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2. Accession

Asaf Khan, rival elimination, Bundela and Lodi suppression.

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3. Frontiers

1636 Deccan settlement; Balkh and Qandahar as limit tests.

4

4. Magnificence

Peacock Throne, Taj, Shahjahanabad as political language.

5

5. Ruling class

Composite service elite under imperial appointment.

6

6. Composition

123 -> 518; wider Indian element, continued immigrant strength.

7

7. Mansab

zat / sawar / dagh / chehra / du-aspa distinctions.

8

8. Effective service

one-third / one-fourth / one-fifth rules; 2000/2000 example.

9

9. Month-scale

jagir, jama, hasil, short-rated yield, Deccan 3-4 months.

10

10. Succession bridge

elite pressure + 1657 illness -> Dharmat / Samugarh -> 1658 outcome.